

Needs Survey on Japanese Language Education & the Japanese Language Proficiency Test (JLPT) from the Kenyan Public

Hello. My name is Njeri K. I am the Chairperson of the Japanese Language Teachers Association of Kenya, and a PhD candidate at Tohoku University.

In line with the mission of promoting Japanese language and culture in Kenya, and advancing practices and strategies related to the same, I would appreciate your voluntary participation in this survey which is part of my PhD project. It will take about 15 minutes or less, but it will go a long way in informing me and other stakeholders of Japanese language education in Kenya on what the Kenyan public needs and what is the best way we can offer it.

If you are Kenyan and are currently learning Japanese, have learned Japanese in the past but stopped learning for whatever reason, or desire to study Japanese in the future, your **honest** response will be of great value. Parents with children who are below the age of 18 may help fill out this form on their children's behalf.

Questions marked with an asterisk (*) require a response from everyone. Questions without an asterisk are to be answered by only those who relate with the details in the question.

All responses will be handled CONFIDENTIALLY. Your cooperation will be highly appreciated.

* Indicates required question

1. Your name/nickname (optional)

2. Gender *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Male

☐ Female

3. Age bracket *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ 11-15
- ☐ 16-20
- ☐ 21-25
- ☐ 26-30
- ☐ 31-35
- ☐ 36-40
- ☐ 41-45
- ☐ 46-50
- ☐ 51-55
- ☐ 56-60
- ☐ 61-65
- ☐ 66-70
- ☐ Above 70

4. Phone number (optional)

5. Email address (optional)

6. Why did/do you desire to learn Japanese (Select all reasons that apply to you) *

Check all that apply.

- ☐ To work in Japan
- ☐ To study in Japan (degree/diploma course, exchange program, etc)
- ☐ To visit Japan
- ☐ I like Japanese culture (tea ceremony, origami, traditional sports like Judo, etc)
- ☐ I like Japanese entertainment (Anime, Manga, Japanese music, Japanese theatre, etc)
- ☐ I like Japanese technology (Artificial Intelligence systems, high speed bullet trains, etc)
- ☐ To do business/trade with Japanese people (importing/exporting, etc)
- ☐ To be employed by a Japanese company/organization in Kenya
- ☐ To be a Japanese language teacher
- ☐ To do a job/business in Kenya that caters to Japanese clients (Japanese restaurant, interpretation, tour guiding, cabin crew, etc)
- ☐ My school/course requires/required me to learn a foreign language
- ☐ My family member/partner/spouse is/was Japanese/living in Japan
- ☐ For fun
- ☐ Other: _____

7. After considering all the reasons why you desire/desired to learn Japanese, what would you choose as your MAIN reason or motivation to study Japanese? (Select only one reason) *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ For employment/work-related/business purposes
- ☐ To study in Japan
- ☐ Foreign language is/was a mandatory subject at my institution/course (I can/could not graduate without taking foreign language lessons)
- ☐ Interest in Japan, Japanese culture/technology, Japanese entertainment, to tour Japan, etc
- ☐ Family/social reasons (marriage/partner/family member living in Japan, to have Japanese friends, for fun, etc)
- ☐ Other: _____

8. Have you ever studied Japanese? *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

9. If you answered "yes" to the above question, are you still studying Japanese?

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

10. For ONLY those who learned/are learning Japanese: For how long have you studied Japanese so far?

Mark only one oval.

☐ Less than 3 months

☐ 3-6 months

☐ 6-9 months

☐ 9 months- 1 year

☐ 1-2 years

☐ 2-3 years

☐ More than 3 years

11. For ONLY those who are learning/have learned Japanese at an institution: Does your institution offer Japanese lessons to the general public? (people who are not enrolled as regular students)

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ I don't know

12. For ONLY those who have NOT YET started learning Japanese: why haven't you started? (Select all reasons that apply to you)

Check all that apply.

- ☐ My school/institution does not offer Japanese
- ☐ I do not know where I can learn Japanese
- ☐ I can not afford to pay for Japanese lessons
- ☐ I am very busy at the moment
- ☐ The time that the lessons are offered clashes with my schedule
- ☐ Lack of learning materials
- ☐ I am very far from the institutions that offer Japanese language
- ☐ I do not have enough courage yet (I think Japanese may be difficult for me)
- ☐ I am still not very sure if I should learn Japanese
- ☐ I just keep postponing (procrastinating)
- ☐ Other: _____

13. For ONLY those that stopped learning Japanese: Why did you stop? (Select all reasons that apply to you)

Check all that apply.

- ☐ I learned up to the level that I wanted/needed to fulfil my goals
- ☐ I learned up to the level that was necessary for me to graduate, and wasn't interested in continuing
- ☐ I could not afford to continue paying for Japanese lessons
- ☐ I wanted to continue, but I completed studies at my school (where I used to access the lessons)
- ☐ My teacher left Kenya
- ☐ My school stopped offering Japanese lessons
- ☐ Japanese language was too hard for me
- ☐ The teaching methodology that was used was not suitable for me
- ☐ I could not get the learning materials/textbooks that I needed to advance
- ☐ I did not pass Japanese exams at school/JLPT and felt discouraged
- ☐ I got busy with other engagements/did not have time to continue studying
- ☐ I decided to learn another language which would be more useful to me/in my life than Japanese
- ☐ I just lost interest in the language
- ☐ Other: _____

14. For ONLY those who are learning/have learned Japanese: Have you started learning any other language AFTER you started learning Japanese?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

15. For ONLY those learning learning another foreign language after starting to learn Japanese: Which foreign language did/do you learn besides Japanese or after you stopped learning Japanese?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Chinese
- ☐ French
- ☐ German
- ☐ Spanish
- ☐ Italian
- ☐ Arabic
- ☐ Other

16. What do you think is the easiest part of learning Japanese? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Reading
- ☐ Writing
- ☐ Listening
- ☐ Speaking
- ☐ I have no idea

17. What do you think is the hardest part of learning Japanese? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Reading
- ☐ Writing
- ☐ Listening
- ☐ Speaking
- ☐ I have no idea

18. For ONLY those who have used a Japanese language text book: Which textbook(s) did you use/are you using? (Either alone or with a teacher) (Select all the answers that apply to you)

Check all that apply.

- ☐ Minna no Nihongo
☐ Genki
☐ Marugoto
☐ Japanese for Busy People
☐ Other: _____

19. For ONLY those who have used a Japanese language textbook: Do you think that the textbook you used/are using is easy for you to understand when you STUDY ALONE?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ No, I need a teacher to explain the content in the book
☐ Yes, I can understand all the content in the book when I study alone
☐ I can understand some content, but not all of it

20. For ONLY those who have used a Japanese language textbook: Give your personal opinion of the textbook that you are currently using (its advantages/disadvantages, what makes it easy/hard to use, etc.)

24. For ONLY those who are learning/have learned Japanese: Do/did you enjoy learning Japanese?

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Somehow

25. FOR EVERYONE: What mode of delivery would you PREFER your teacher/institution to use for Japanese lessons? This applies to all, including those studying by themselves (assuming that a teacher was available to teach them).

*

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Online
- ☐ Physical (face-to-face)
- ☐ Both online and physical

26. For ONLY those who are learning/have learned Japanese: Where do you/did you learn Japanese?

Check all that apply.

- ☐ Self-study
- ☐ Private lessons with a tutor
- ☐ Kenyatta University
- ☐ USIU-Africa
- ☐ Utalii College
- ☐ JKUAT
- ☐ Strathmore University
- ☐ Nairobi University
- ☐ At an institution in Japan (either online or physical)
- ☐ KWS Training Institute
- ☐ Egerton University
- ☐ Statehouse Girls
- ☐ Karamu Academy
- ☐ KIFLAPS
- ☐ Catholic University of Eastern Africa
- ☐ Tenri School
- ☐ Language Connections Centre
- ☐ Embu University
- ☐ Nairobi Aviation College
- ☐ Other: _____

About the Japanese Language Proficiency Test (JLPT)

The JLPT is a test that is done worldwide to measure your Japanese Proficiency. In Kenya, it is done every first Sunday of December. With a JLPT certificate, you can prove your Japanese language proficiency to a potential employer, school, etc.

27. Have you ever HEARD ABOUT the Japanese Language Proficiency Test (JLPT)? *
- The JLPT is a test that is done worldwide to measure your Japanese Proficiency.

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

28. Have you ever taken the JLPT? *

Mark only one oval.

☐ Yes

☐ No

29. For **ONLY** those who have ALREADY TAKEN THE JLPT: What is the highest level of the exam you have taken so far?

From 2010, N1 is the highest level and N5 is the lowest.

Before 2010, Level 1 was the highest level and Level 4 was the lowest.

Mark only one oval.

☐ N5

☐ N4

☐ N3

☐ N2

☐ N1

☐ Level 4

☐ Level 3

☐ Level 2

☐ Level 1

30. Would you like to get a JLPT certificate of your Japanese language proficiency now or in the future? (And if you already have a certificate, would you like to get certified for a higher level?) *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Maybe/ I am not sure
- ☐ I already have a certificate of the highest level I intended to get
- ☐ I did JLPT in the past and did not pass, and I am not motivated to do it again
- ☐ Other: _____

31. For ONLY those who may have **desired to do JLPT** but **have not managed to do it yet**/feel they will not manage to do it: What was/is the obstacle? (check as many boxes as applicable)

Note: People who have just started learning and those who have not yet started learning Japanese do not need to respond to this question.

Check all that apply.

- ☐ I do not have someone/a teacher to help me prepare for the exam
- ☐ I do not know/have materials/books to help me study for the test
- ☐ I do not have time to study for the exam
- ☐ I am not able to afford the JLPT fees
- ☐ I am far from the test centre
- ☐ I do not have enough information regarding JLPT (where it is conducted, when it is conducted, etc)
- ☐ I have just been procrastinating (pushing it to the future)
- ☐ Other: _____

Appreciation/Final Remarks (OPTIONAL)

Thank you very much for your participation in this Survey!

32. Please provide any additional comments/remarks about your experience of learning Japanese, or what you would like to tell Japanese language education stakeholders in Kenya, in 100 words or less.

This content is neither created nor endorsed by Google.

Google Forms